

Of Goan escapes, birthday blues, Ladakh thrills... and Mumbai mayhem

July arrived with the kind of dramatic flair that makes soap operas look understated. Ashwani escaped to Goa's beaches – but not before executing the ultimate office prank: casually dunking Sakunthala's Nord CE3 Lite into water just to watch her world momentarily crumble. Meanwhile, Raja's PG food situation reached crisis levels, with homesickness hitting harder than a failed firmware update. Back in Mumbai, Mithun finally caught a break from endless GPU and CPU reviews when he got his hands on a brand-new ASUS NUC – a tiny Windows PC packing enough punch to give the Mac mini a run for its money. The rest of the Mumbai crew agree it's been the happiest they've seen him all year.

The month's challenges weren't limited to culinary complaints. Ayushi found herself locked in an ongoing standoff with the office's unofficial stray-dog security team, who've apparently decided her scooty parking spot is prime real estate worth defending. And then there was Ravi, whose month took a genuinely awful turn when thieves broke into his home and made off with his laptop, iPhone, earbuds, and ID card – basically everything that makes modern life functional. Over in Mumbai, Jayesh's sister's laptop took a minor two-foot plunge and promptly "played dead," with official service quoting a repair cost so astronomical it was as good as getting a brand new laptop. Enter Lamington Road's finest fixer:

jaws dropped when Jayesh got it back as good as new for less than an annual subscription of Netflix. Gotta love that kinda jugaad, right?

Across the Atlantic, Manas witnessed Samsung's New York Unpacked spectacle, where the Galaxy Z Fold 7, Flip 7, Flip 7 FE, and Watch 8 series made their grand debuts. Back home, our Amazon Live video marathon intensified, with Mustafa making his streaming debut in what's becoming our most demanding content month yet. On the Mumbai front, Vyom leveled up beyond feature-writing when he interviewed Steven Riley, Head of IT Operations and Service Management at Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team – quizzing him on the cutting-edge

tech behind those jaw-dropping F1 simulators. Combining his motorsports obsession with his tech passion? Cherry. On. Top.

But July's darkest moment came on Yash's birthday, when Delhi's torrential rains turned celebration into

crisis: a serious accident landed him in the hospital requiring surgery, reminding everyone that sometimes life's plot twists aren't the entertaining kind. On a brighter note, SKOAR! welcomed Aryan Malik as Executive Operations, taking charge of everything from college partnerships to student community management – essentially masterminding our gaming empire's ground-level domination. Elsewhere, Sid stepped into TV review territory under Deepak's expert guidance, while Skoar launched their inaugural podcast with RakaZone Gaming's Rishab Karanwal.

The month closed on a high (and a dizzying altitude): Mustafa, Narendra, and Apurva headed to Ladakh's breathtaking landscapes for what promised to be an epic video shoot – because nothing says "work-life balance" quite like combining stunning cinematography with altitude-sickness risks. So, here's to August: may the Wi-Fi be strong, the pranks be legendary, and the travel adapters never get lost in transit. 

QUOTE OF THE MONTH

"Perplexity Pro? It's Perplexity bro!"

—Everyone who got it free via Airtel

